

In Topic 1, you learnt about the basics of project management. Now, let's explore the application of project management for IT-related projects.

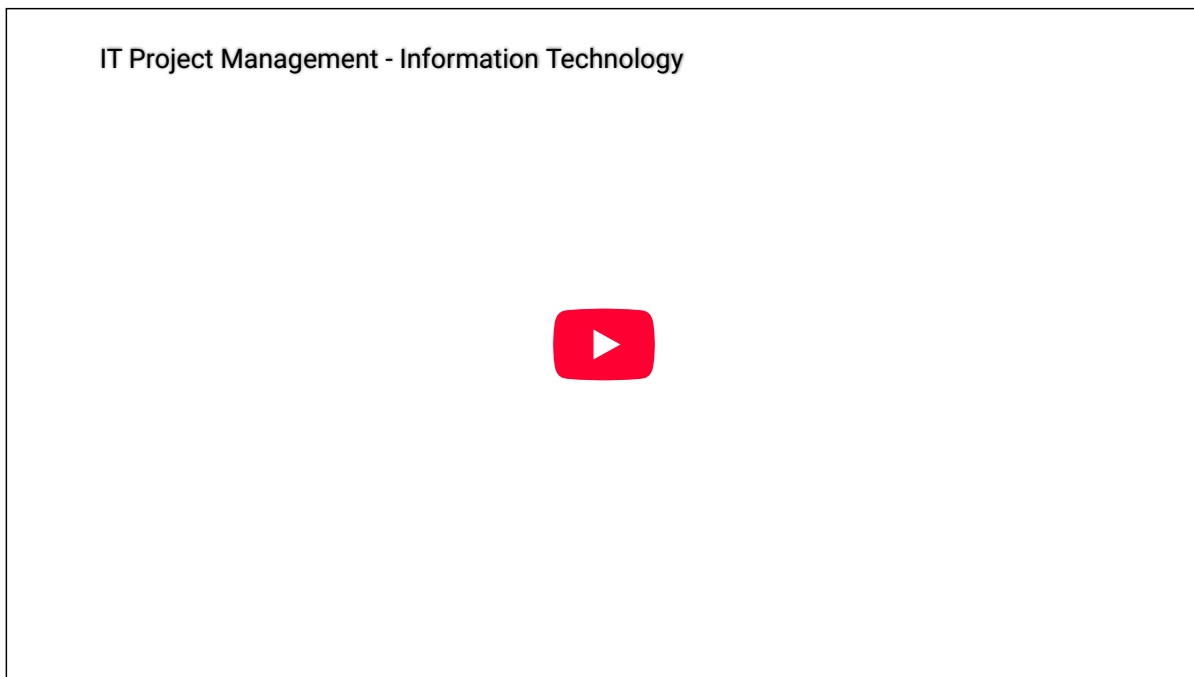
In this topic, you will watch videos, complete readings and participate in discussions to understand the application of project management for an IT project.

But, before you begin, participate in the discussion below.

 **Discuss**

IT project management

1. **Watch** this video "IT project management — information technology [6.11 min]" to learn how to manage IT projects and understand the differences between IT project management and normal project management.



© 2014 by ProjectManager. *IT project management — information technology*

2. **Share** your answers to the following questions via the padlet below.
 - What are some of the key takeaways from the video above?
 - What differentiates IT project management from normal project management?
3. **Review** your classmates' posts. Is there anything in their experience that is new to you? Comment constructively on at least two posts.

To use the padlet

Double click anywhere on the board or tap/click on the pink + to add to the padlet. If you want to open the padlet fullscreen, click on the 'open in new' icon in the top right of the padlet screen. Get creative with photos, videos, LinkedIn profile URLs and more.

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Anonymous

5 months ago

Anonymous

Key Takeaways from the Video

RHIANNON RIGBY + 35M

1. IT Projects Have Many Parts

- They involve business goals, technology, and management tasks.
- Key areas include software, hardware.

Anonymous

5 months ago

Key Takeaways

1. Dynamic Changes

Multiple components in IT keep on changing such as hardware and software due to introduction of advanced technology. So it is important to monitor these

1. High Complexity and Rapid Changes

– IT projects deal with evolving technologies, frequent updates

Anonymous

5 months ago

The differences between IT project management and normal project management

Q

SHARE

1. High Complexity and Rapid Changes

– IT projects deal with evolving technologies, frequent updates

Made with Padlet

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[Why study IT project management?](#) →

Today, information technology is being used and applied in almost every organisation. From Fortune 500 companies to start-ups to unicorns, every organisation is adopting new ways of doing business that are often reliant on the use of IT. Therefore, now more than ever, organisations need IT project managers who are able to execute projects to allow the organisations to grow and achieve success.

You will now explore the various aspects of IT project management that will help you understand the need and demand for good IT project managers.

What skills do IT project managers need?

“

To be successful, IT project managers need a variety of both technical and soft skills. First, they need IT knowledge and experience; they must be knowledgeable about hardware, software, networking, infrastructure, and data and network security. They also need the ability to analyse and draw conclusions from data to develop effective solutions. Since they are responsible for budgeting, allocating resources, and managing both data and the timeline for the project, IT project managers must also be excellent and highly organized planners.

Technical skills aren't the only kind these project managers need, though. As the de facto leaders of their project teams, they also must possess excellent communication, people, and leadership skills. These soft skills are essential considering IT project managers may work with a variety of outside teams within the organization, such as those in charge of business data, security and compliance, and procurement.

”

(Wrike, n.d.)

Attributes of IT projects

IT projects can have several layers of complexity. Managing stakeholders and communicating challenges to colleagues who don't have an IT background can often become hurdles in the successful delivery of an IT project.

Let's explore some key attributes of IT projects.



Read

Read the article [Definitions, characteristics and measures of IT project complexity — a systematic literature review](#) (Morcov et al., 2020), which is a literature review that intends to 'identify and classify proposed definitions and measures of IT project complexity' (Morcov et al., 2020, p. 5).

Recent trends affecting IT project management

The field of IT is constantly evolving. This means that IT project managers have to evolve to be able to adopt new trends and practices and keep up with the pace.

The video below explores some of the recent IT trends and how it affects project management.



Watch

Watch this video "Modern IT trends and their effect on project management [5.46 min]" to learn about modern IT trends and their effect on project management.

Modern IT Trends and Their Effect on Project Management



© 2018 by Racdoom. *Modern IT trends and their effect on project management*



Read

This article [The state of IT in 2022: Why IT teams need flexible project management](#) (Allen, 2022) explores current challenges for IT departments, including solutions and trends driving the need to work closely with departments outside of IT.



Resources

Learn about more about IT project management by reading the article [16 industry experts share best practices for IT project management](#) (Forbes Technology Council, 2022).

[← Topic 2: Project management in an IT context](#)

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[Systemic view of project management →](#)

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The systems view or systems approach examines the project context (i.e. business, organisation and technology) from a broader level in a holistic manner to align the project management activities with the needs of the organisations. This is especially important for projects related to complex situations and dynamic environments.

Resources

Learn about how systems thinking is used in project management by reading the report [*Systems thinking: How is it used in project management?*](#) (Association for Project Management, 2018).



[← Why study IT project management?](#)

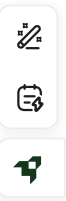
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[Project phase and project life cycle →](#)

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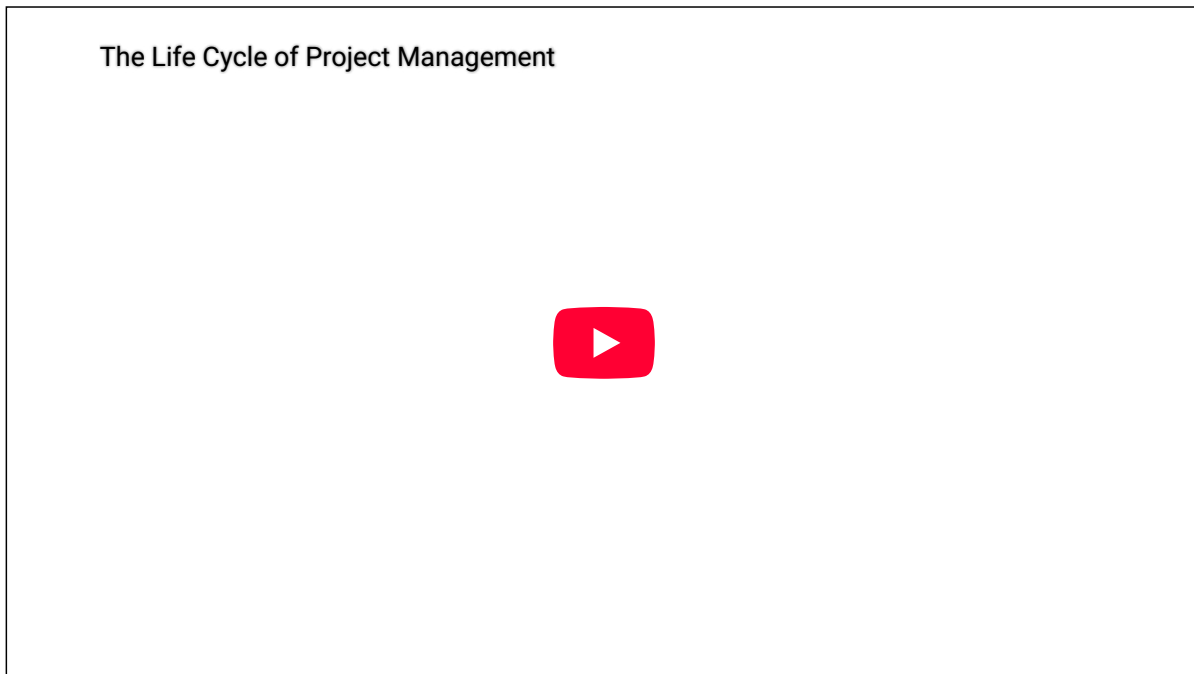
To be able to execute a project, it is important for the project manager to understand the project life cycle. This will enable the project manager to identify the different stakeholders and pre-empt challenges that may arise at a later stage.

The videos below will help you understand the phases in a project life cycle and the difference between a phase and process groups.



Watch

Watch this video "The life cycle of project management [6.02 min]" to learn about the project life cycle as the path a project manager will use to break the project down into stages, making it easier to delegate tasks and manage team workloads.



© 2021 by Wrike. *The life cycle of project management*



Watch

Watch this video "Project life cycle vs phase vs process groups in project management [6.53 min]" to understand the differences between project life cycle, phase and process groups in project management through illustrative examples.

Project Life Cycle vs Phase vs Process Groups in Project Management | PMBOK Guide | P...



© 2019 by PmbyPM. *Project life cycle vs phase vs process groups in project management*

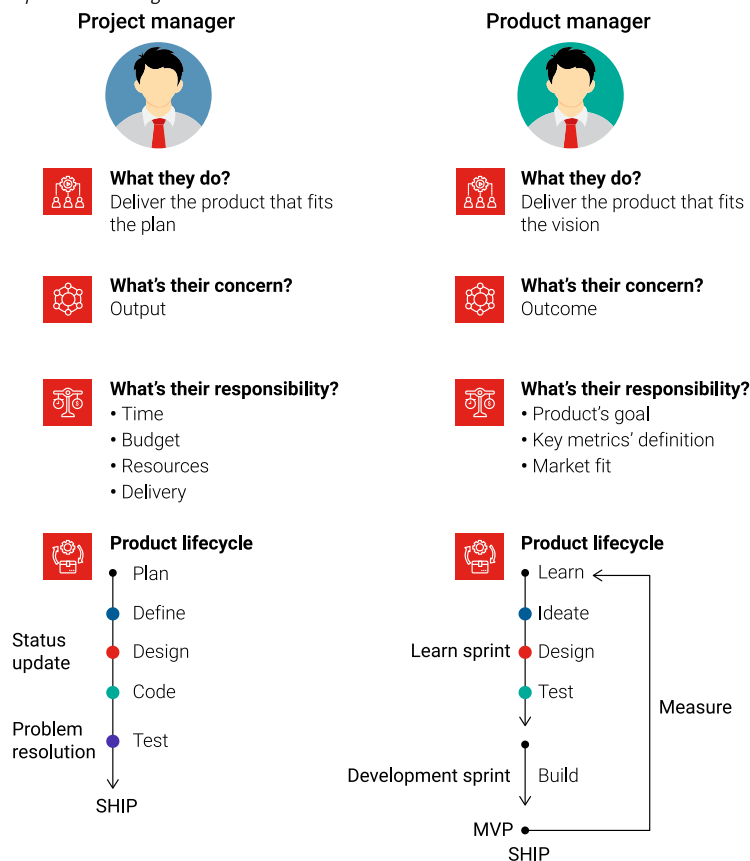
Project versus product development

There is often confusion between the roles and responsibilities of a project manager and a product manager. This confusion can lead to delays in the execution of a project and impact the quality of the project. It is critical for an IT project manager to understand the full scope of their roles and responsibilities to be able to deliver a project successfully.

Figure 1.1 illustrates the differences between a project manager and product manager.

Figure 1.1

Project manager versus product manager



(Click to expand the image)

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[\[Image transcript\]](#)

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[Organisational structure and culture →](#)

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Apart from the skills and expertise of an IT project manager, there are various external factors that can impact the success of a project. A successful project manager is a person who can manoeuvre through these external challenges and lead the project to completion.

One such external factor is the organisational structure and culture. An organisation that is resistant to change will pose a greater challenge as compared to organisations that are early adopters of technology. It is the role of the project manager to understand organisational structure and culture and develop a strategy to execute an IT project successfully.

**Read**

The article [*Organizational culture, how to define, implement and nurture*](#) (Puscasu, 2022) explores the definition of organisational culture, including 10 primary characteristics that capture the essence of an organisational culture.

**Discuss**

Case analysis on company culture

In this discussion you will watch a video "Company culture.avi [3.03 min]" containing a mini case study and answer questions.

Company Culture.avi



© 2011 by Tracy O'Rourke. *Company culture.avi*

1. **Answer** the following questions:

- What type of company culture did you identify?
- Did you recognise any member identity?
- Was it member- or manager-focused?
- Were the control levels high or low?
- Do they have a risk tolerance?
- What were the reward criteria?

- ## To use the padlet

2/3



Another challenge faced by IT project managers is resistance from key stakeholders. While a project manager is in charge of the project, some decisions have to be made by key stakeholders involved in the overall governance of an organisation. For a project manager, one of the critical skills is stakeholder management.

Let's look at an example. You are managing an IT project and you need to hire two new employees in the IT department for a full upgrade of the company's data security infrastructure. To hire two new employees, you need to consult the human resources manager of the organisation and engage them for their support in identifying and recruiting the two employees. However, the human resources manager does not understand the need for two new employees. According to the human resource manager, the current employees should be able to do the job, as hiring new employees increases the financial burden on the organisation. The resistance is primarily because the human resource manager does not understand the skills required to perform the upgrade of the system. It is the responsibility of the IT project manager to explain the need for additional resources in a way that can be understood by the human resource manager. This is where effective stakeholder management becomes crucial.

A clear definition of stakeholder management is outlined below.

“

Stakeholder management is the process by which you organize, monitor and improve your relationships with your stakeholders.

It involves systematically identifying stakeholders; analyzing their needs and expectations; and planning and implementing various tasks to engage with them. A good stakeholder management process will be the means through which you are able to coordinate your interactions and assess the status and quality of your relationship with various stakeholders.

”

(Darzin, n.d.)



Read

This article [Planning effective stakeholder management strategies to do the same thing!](#) (Baker, 2012) explains the importance of addressing and involving stakeholders in the development of a project.

← Organisational structure and culture

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Workshop 2 →

